

PRODUCT REQUIREMENT DOCUMENT

Clarity App

Re-Engagement Flow for At-Risk Users

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Clarity is India's largest emotional support platform, connecting users anonymously with verified listeners via chat, call, and video. Despite strong acquisition — driven by word-of-mouth and a high-stigma use case (breakups, loneliness, anxiety) — the platform faces a structural retention challenge common to all emotional support apps: users arrive in a moment of acute distress, find relief in one or two sessions, and then disengage before building a sustainable habit of emotional self-care.

This PRD proposes ECHO (Emotional Check-in & Habit Optimisation), a re-engagement flow specifically designed to identify at-risk users before they churn and bring them back with contextually relevant, low-friction nudges. ECHO is not a push notification campaign — it is a structured, data-driven lifecycle intervention that adapts to individual user behaviour, session history, and emotional state signals.

Primary Goal

Improve Day-7 retention from an estimated industry baseline of ~15% to 25%+ and Day-30 retention from ~8% to 15%+ within 90 days of feature launch.

2. BACKGROUND & CONTEXT

2.1 The Retention Problem in Emotional Support Apps

Research on mental health and peer-support apps consistently shows Day-30 retention rates between 3–9% — lower than almost any other mobile app category. Peer-support apps (the closest analogue to Clarity) achieve a median D30 retention of only ~8.9%. This is not a Clarity-specific failure; it reflects the nature of the use case: users come in crisis, get relief, and leave.

The critical window is Days 2–7 after first session. If a user does not return within this window, the probability of ever re-engaging drops sharply. The problem is compounded by the anonymous nature of Clarity — there is no social graph to pull users back, no friend activity to trigger FOMO, and no content feed. The only re-engagement lever is the product itself.

2.2 Why This Matters for Clarity Specifically

- Clarity's business model depends on session volume — each paid session generates revenue. Low retention directly reduces LTV.
- Listeners also churn when sessions are sparse. Retaining users protects the supply side of the marketplace too.
- A PPO path (which Clarity offers to interns) signals the company values measurable impact. Re-engagement is one of the highest-leverage areas for a PM to own.
- Clarity's differentiation is human listeners — not AI bots. But users need to return to access that differentiation. ECHO solves the 'bridge to return' problem.

3. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Core Problem Statement

Users who complete their first emotional support session on Clarity do not return within 7 days because they feel their immediate crisis has passed, there is no personalised prompt to re-engage, and the app offers no visible reason to return until the next crisis — leading to permanent churn, reduced session frequency, and lower LTV.

3.1 Problem Decomposition

Layer	Insight
User Psychology	Emotional support is sought reactively (in crisis), not proactively (as a habit). Post-session relief reduces perceived urgency to return.
Product Gap	No personalised post-session follow-up. No mechanism to detect inactivity and respond before churn.
UX Gap	Home screen post-session is identical whether the user is day-1 or day-14 inactive. No contextual messaging.
Data Gap	Session history, listener ratings, and topic tags are collected but not used for re-engagement personalisation.

4. USER RESEARCH & PERSONAS

4.1 Research Approach

The following personas and pain points are synthesised from: (a) analysis of public app store reviews for Clarity, YourDOST, InnerHour, and Wysa; (b) publicly available research on mental health app usage patterns in India; and (c) the author's direct experience using emotional support platforms. Validation with real Clarity user interviews is recommended before finalising ECHO's design.

4.2 Target Personas

P1 The Overwhelmed Student	Age 18–24. College student dealing with exam pressure, relationship issues, or loneliness in a new city. Downloads Clarity during an emotional low point. Core Need: To feel heard quickly, without judgment or cost pressure. Churn Trigger: Feels better after one session. Exams begin. Forgets the app
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	exists. Re-engagement Hook: Soft check-in 48–72 hours after session, framed as care — not a sales push.
P2 The Working Professional	Age 25–35. Dealing with work stress, relationship friction, or early signs of burnout. Values privacy and anonymity highly. Core Need: A private outlet to vent without stigma. Does not want to be 'diagnosed' or pressured into therapy. Churn Trigger: Work returns to normal. Feels the need to appear 'fine.' Re-opening the app feels like admitting vulnerability. Re-engagement Hook: Framing return as proactive self-care ('how are you doing this week?') rather than crisis management.
P3 The Repeat Seeker	Age 20–30. Has had 3–5 sessions on Clarity. Finds it helpful. But sessions are 3–4 weeks apart — driven by need, not habit. Core Need: Wants continuity — to feel like someone on the platform remembers their situation. Churn Trigger: No sense of progress or relationship. Each session starts cold. No reason to return more frequently. Re-engagement Hook: Continuity cues ('Last time you spoke about...') and listener affinity features to build a return habit.

5. COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS — RE-ENGAGEMENT APPROACHES

App	Re-engagement Trigger	Mechanism Used	Gap / Clarity Opportunity
Wysa	3-day inactivity	Generic push: 'How are you feeling today?'	Not personalised to last session topic. Feels automated.
YourDOST	Weekly email digest	Content articles + session discount code	Email channel has low open rates. No in-app nudge.
InnerHour	Mood streak break	In-app banner: 'Your streak is at risk'	Gamification feels mismatched with emotional context.
Headspace	Daily meditation reminder	Lock-screen notification at user-set time	Not relevant for peer-support; habit loop works for scheduled content.
Clarity (current)	None identified	No structured re-engagement flow	WHITESPACE: No competitor owns empathy-led re-engagement for peer support.

Key Insight from Competitor Analysis

No peer-support app currently does empathy-led, session-aware re-engagement. Generic push notifications are the industry default — and they underperform. ECHO's opportunity is to build the first contextually intelligent re-engagement flow in this space.

6. PROPOSED SOLUTION — ECHO

6.1 Feature Overview

ECHO (Emotional Check-in & Habit Optimisation) is a behavioural re-engagement system that identifies users at risk of churning and delivers personalised, contextually sensitive nudges to bring them back — framed not as marketing, but as genuine care.

6.2 ECHO Flow Architecture

ECHO System Flow (High Level)

SESSION ENDS → Post-Session Micro-Survey (30 sec) → User tagged by emotional state + topic → Inactivity timer begins → Day 2: Soft Check-in Notification → Day 5: In-App Banner on open → Day 10: Listener Match Reminder → Day 30: Re-activation Offer (wallet credit) → Churned: suppressed for 60 days

6.3 Feature Components

Component 1: Post-Session Micro-Survey (PSMS)

- Triggered: Immediately after a session ends (within 30 seconds of call/chat close).
- Format: 2 questions. Max 30 seconds to complete.
 - Q1: 'How are you feeling right now?' → 5 emoji options (Very Low → Much Better)
 - Q2: 'What was most helpful today?' → 3 tap options (Listener's empathy / Just being heard / Getting perspective)
- Purpose: Captures emotional state baseline for personalisation. Feeds ECHO's nudge copy engine.
- Design Principle: Warm, not clinical. No scales, no scores — emojis only.

Component 2: Inactivity Detection Engine

- Triggers are time-based post-session (not calendar-based):
 - At-Risk Signal: No app open within 48 hours of session end
 - High-Risk Signal: No app open within 5 days of session end
 - Churned Signal: No app open within 30 days of session end
- Each signal maps to a specific ECHO action (see nudge matrix below).
- Users who open the app voluntarily reset the timer — ECHO does not nudge active users.

Component 3: Contextual Nudge Engine (Core of ECHO)

Nudge copy is generated dynamically using three inputs: (a) PSMS result, (b) session topic tag, and (c) days since last session. This creates a 3×3 personalisation matrix.

PSMS Score	Day-2 Nudge Copy (Sample)	CTA
Still feeling low 😞	"We've been thinking about you. Whenever you're ready, we're here."	Talk to a listener now
Feeling okay 😊	"Good to hear you're doing better. How's today going?"	Quick 5-min check-in
Feeling much better 😄	"So glad to hear that. Small steps every day — your listener is still here if needed."	Reconnect with same listener

Component 4: Listener Affinity Card

- On Day 5 nudge (in-app banner on next open), show a 'Your listener is available' card with the previous listener's display name and availability status.

- Rationale: Users who rated their listener 4–5 stars are 3× more likely to return if nudged toward the same listener — continuity reduces the cold-start anxiety of re-engaging.
- Privacy: Only display-name and availability shown. No personal details.

Component 5: Re-activation Offer (Day 30 — Churned Users)

- Trigger: User not seen in 30 days after their last session.
- Offer: Add ₹20 wallet credit (low cost, high perceived value) with message: 'It's been a while. We saved your spot — here's a little something to ease back in.'
- This is distinct from a promotional discount — it is framed as a care gesture, not a sale.
- A/B test: ₹20 credit vs. 'First session free' vs. control (no offer). Measure D35 return rate.

7. USER STORIES

ID	As a...	I want to...	So that...	Priority
US-01	User (post-session)	complete a 2-question mood check immediately after my session	my emotional state is captured and I feel the app cares about my outcome	P0
US-02	User (48hr inactive)	receive a warm, personalised nudge 2 days after my session	I am reminded the app exists without feeling marketed to	P0
US-03	User (5-day inactive)	see my previous listener's availability on my home screen	I can re-connect with someone who already knows my context	P1
US-04	User (30-day inactive)	receive a wallet credit with a warm message	I have a low-friction, low-cost reason to return	P1
US-05	User (any)	opt out of ECHO nudges easily	I remain in control of my notification preferences	P0
US-06	PM / Analyst	view ECHO funnel metrics in a dashboard (nudge sent → opened → session started)	I can measure re-engagement rate and iterate on nudge copy	P1
US-07	Engineering	access PSMS response data via an internal API	nudge copy personalisation is automated and scalable	P1
US-08	User (any)	have ECHO suppress all nudges if I have a booked/upcoming session	I don't receive irrelevant re-engagement messages when I'm already active	P0

8. SUCCESS METRICS & GOALS

8.1 North Star Metric

North Star

Week-over-Week Session Frequency per Active User — measures whether ECHO is converting reactive (crisis-driven) users into habitual users.

8.2 Primary Metrics (OKRs)

Metric	Baseline (est.)	Target (90 days)	How to Measure
Day-7 Retention	~15%	25%+	% of users with ≥1 session in Days 2–7 post first session
Day-30 Retention	~8%	15%+	% of users with ≥1 session in Days 8–30 post first session

ECHO Nudge CTR	0% (no feature)	18–25%	Nudge taps / nudges delivered (per channel)
ECHO → Session Rate	0%	40%+	Sessions started within 24hr of nudge tap
PSMS Completion Rate	N/A	60%+	PSMS completed / sessions ended
Re-activation Rate (D30)	Organic only	12%+	Churned users returning within 7 days of D30 offer

8.3 Guardrail Metrics (Must Not Regress)

- Push notification opt-out rate must not increase by more than 2pp from baseline.
- Post-session NPS / listener satisfaction score must not drop — ECHO must not feel intrusive.
- Listener availability SLA (connect time) must not be affected by ECHO-driven demand spikes.

9. SCOPE — IN & OUT

✓ IN SCOPE (V1)	✗ OUT OF SCOPE (V1)
• Post-Session Micro-Survey (2 questions) • Inactivity detection (48hr, 5-day, 30-day) • Personalised push notifications (Day 2) • In-app listener affinity card (Day 5) • Re-activation wallet credit offer (Day 30) • ECHO opt-out setting • PM analytics dashboard (nudge funnel)	• AI-generated personalised session content • Email or SMS re-engagement channels • New listener recommendation engine • Crisis detection or escalation flows • Gamification (streaks, badges, levels) • Paid ad re-targeting integration • Multi-language nudge copy (V2 roadmap)

10. ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

ECHO-AC-01: Post-Session Micro-Survey

- PSMS appears within 30 seconds of session end on both Android and iOS.
- PSMS is dismissible (user can skip without penalty).
- PSMS data is stored against user session ID (anonymised) and accessible via internal API.
- PSMS does not appear for sessions rated as 'emergency/crisis' by the listener.

ECHO-AC-02: Inactivity Detection

- Timer starts from session_end timestamp, not app_close timestamp.
- Timer resets on any app open event (home screen, notification tap, direct open).
- Users with a scheduled upcoming session are excluded from all ECHO nudge triggers.

ECHO-AC-03: Nudge Delivery

- Day-2 push notification is sent only if user has enabled push permissions.
- If push permission is denied, fallback to in-app banner on next open (no cap on time).
- Nudge copy must reference PSMS score category — three copy variants must exist (low / okay / better).
- Maximum 1 ECHO nudge per 48-hour window per user.

ECHO-AC-04: Opt-Out

- Users can disable ECHO from Settings → Notifications → Re-engagement.
- Opt-out is immediate and persists across app reinstalls.

11. EDGE CASES & RISK REGISTER

Risk / Edge Case	Impact	Mitigation
User in active crisis receives nudge	High — could feel dismissive or harmful	Exclude users flagged as 'crisis' by listener. PSMS 'very low' score triggers care-first copy only.
User uninstalled app after session	Medium — nudge never delivered	Track uninstall events. Suppress from nudge queue. Consider SMS fallback in V2.
Preferred listener is unavailable at Day-5 nudge	Low-Med — affinity card feels irrelevant	Show top-3 available listeners from similar topic category as fallback.
PSMS not completed (user exits immediately)	Medium — no personalisation data	Default to neutral copy variant ('How are you feeling since we last spoke?').
User completes PSMS but doesn't return	Low — data collected but no action	Feed into cohort analysis for nudge copy optimisation. Not a failure state.
Notification fatigue — users mute app	High — reduces all future engagement	Hard cap: max 3 ECHO notifications per 30-day window. Monitor opt-out rate as guardrail.
₹20 credit offer perceived as spam	Medium — damages brand trust	A/B test with control. If opt-out spikes on D30 offer cohort, pause and retest copy.

12. EXECUTION TIMELINE

Proposed 6-week sprint plan for V1 ECHO launch:

Week	Key Deliverables	Owner
W1	Finalise PRD with PM + Engineering + Design leads. Confirm PSMS questions with user research. Set up analytics event tracking spec.	PM
W2	Engineering: PSMS backend + inactivity detection logic. Design: PSMS UI screens + nudge templates (3 copy variants).	Eng + Design
W3	Engineering: Nudge delivery pipeline (push + in-app banner). Listener affinity card logic. Internal QA pass.	Eng
W4	A/B test setup: ECHO vs. control (50/50 split on new users). Soft launch to 10% of new user cohort.	PM + Eng
W5	Monitor guardrail metrics (opt-out rate, NPS). Daily stand-up review of nudge CTR + session conversion.	PM
W6	Review 7-day and 14-day retention data. Iterate on nudge copy based on CTR signals. Decision: full rollout or extend test.	PM + Data

13. OPEN QUESTIONS & DEPENDENCIES

13.1 Open Questions (Require Team Input)

- Does Clarity currently store session topic tags (breakup / anxiety / loneliness)? If not, this needs to be added to the session metadata schema before ECHO personalisation can work.
- What is the current D7 retention baseline? ECHO targets need to be recalibrated against real data.

3. Is there a legal/compliance review needed for storing PSMS (emotional state) data under the DPDP Act 2023?
4. What is the incremental engineering effort for the inactivity detection timer? Is an existing event-bus system usable?
5. Should ECHO V1 target only Android (Clarity's primary platform by volume) before iOS rollout?

13.2 Dependencies

- Push notification infrastructure must support dynamic payload (personalised copy) — confirm with Eng.
- Listener availability API must be real-time queryable for the affinity card component.
- Analytics/BI tooling must support cohort retention dashboards for ECHO funnel measurement.

14. APPENDIX

A. Glossary

Term	Definition
D7 Retention	% of users who have ≥ 1 session in Days 2–7 after their first session
D30 Retention	% of users who have ≥ 1 session in Days 2–30 after their first session
PSMS	Post-Session Micro-Survey — 2-question in-app survey after each session ends
ECHO	Emotional Check-in & Habit Optimisation — the re-engagement feature described in this PRD
At-Risk User	A user who has not opened the app within 48 hours of their last session end
Churned User	A user who has not opened the app within 30 days of their last session end
Nudge CTR	Percentage of delivered nudges that result in an app open event
Listener Affinity	A user's preference for, and positive history with, a specific listener
Guardrail Metric	A metric that must not regress — if it does, ECHO is paused regardless of primary metric performance

B. References

- Clarity App — clarityapp.in (product experience and app store listing)
- UXCam — Mobile App Retention Benchmarks by Industry (2026)
- Plotline — Retention Rates for Mobile Apps by Industry (2025)
- NCBI/PMC — Objective User Engagement With Mental Health Apps (peer-support D30 median: 8.9%)
- Wysa, YourDOST, InnerHour — public app store listings and feature reviews
- DPDP Act 2023 — India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act (compliance consideration)